



FOR THE COMMITTEE · BEFORE YOU VOTE

The committee decision pack

Everything an owners corporation committee needs to review GoodStrata and decide in a single meeting: the case for switching, a line-by-line comparison against a traditional strata manager, honest answers to the hard questions, and a resolution you can copy onto the agenda.

\$0

Cost to the
owners
corporation

100%

Of actions on an
append-only
audit log

0

Insurance
commissions or
contractor
kickbacks

What GoodStrata is

GoodStrata is an open-source platform that runs the operational work of an owners corporation with AI agents: issuing levies, chasing arrears, triaging maintenance and dispatching contractors, and preparing meeting notices and minutes. The committee and owners do not do the admin — they approve, vote, or escalate through a decisions inbox. The agents can only propose; a human approval executes anything with legal or financial weight, and every action lands on an append-only event log you can read down to each model tool-call. The money maths — levy apportionment, penalty interest, reconciliation, vote weighting — is deterministic, tested code, never the language model.

How to use this pack

Pages 2–3 make the case and set GoodStrata side-by-side against your current manager. Page 4 answers the five questions every committee asks — data safety, liability, cost, being wrong, and the switching process in Victoria. Page 5 gives you resolution wording to copy and a next-steps checklist. Nothing in this pack is legal advice; it is enough to decide with confidence and plan the timeline.

SECTION 1

The case for switching

Most owners corporations pay a manager \$300–\$600 per lot every year, and most of what that buys is administration: issuing the levies, chasing arrears, booking the plumber, sending the AGM notice. That work is now automatable, end-to-end, with a human approving the decisions that matter. Switching is not about firing a person — it is about paying for judgement, not paperwork, and seeing every dollar and every action on the record.

Five reasons a committee moves

1. It is free for the owners corporation. No subscription, no per-lot management fee, no setup charge. Self-host it on your own database, or use the hosted free tier. GoodStrata earns a small, published margin only on payments that actually move — levies in and contractor payments out — and sells a paid managed-hosting service for buildings that don't want to run it. That is the whole business model.
2. The conflicts of interest are gone. A conventional manager can earn invisible commissions on the insurance they place for your building and kickbacks from the contractors they appoint. GoodStrata takes none of that. The AI never ranks a contractor by what GoodStrata earns — the margin is identical whichever contractor wins — so the committee chooses purely on the quotes and evidence attached.
3. You stay in control. Every budget, every quote over your threshold, every vote still stops at a decision gate and waits for a human. The software proposes; the committee decides. Role-gated approvals mean office-bearers see only what is theirs to sign.
4. Everything is auditable. Every read and write — human or agent — is an event on an append-only log, stamped with the actor, the amount to the cent, and the timestamp. “Who touched what, and on what evidence?” is a question with an exact answer, not a filing-cabinet guess.
5. The money maths is not left to an AI. Levy apportionment, penalty interest, payment reconciliation and vote weighting run as deterministic, tested code. If every language model were swapped for a random-number generator tomorrow, your levies would still sum to the budget to the cent.

The one line for the agenda

“Review GoodStrata: a free, open-source, audit-first platform that runs our levies, arrears, maintenance and meetings with AI agents under committee approval, with no insurance commissions and no contractor kickbacks. Ten-minute live demo at demo.goodstrata.com.au.”

SECTION 2

Side-by-side: GoodStrata vs a traditional manager

The same building, the same work — priced and governed two different ways. Figures are typical Victorian ranges; your contract sets the exact numbers.

	GoodStrata	Traditional strata manager
Cost to the OC	\$0 — free to self-host or on the hosted free tier	Management fee, commonly \$300–\$600 per lot per year
Insurance commission	None — the committee chooses at renewal; GoodStrata's revenue does not change	Often an undisclosed commission on the premium placed
Contractor kickbacks	None — no trade pays to be in the pool or to be picked	Referral fees or margins on appointed contractors are common
Contractor ranking	AI never orders contractors by what GoodStrata earns — same margin either way	Incentive to steer work to paying trades
Who decides	Committee approves every budget, quote over threshold, and vote; agents only propose	Manager acts under delegation; owners often see the outcome after the fact
Transparency	Every action on an append-only audit log — actor, amount, timestamp, tool-call	Periodic statements; the workings are rarely visible
The admin work	Levies, arrears, maintenance triage, notices and minutes run by AI agents 24/7	Manual, in business hours, at the pace of one portfolio manager
Money calculations	Deterministic, tested code — reconciled to the cent, independent of the AI	Manual or opaque back-office systems
Your data	Open-source; self-host on your own database, or hosted in Australia under the APPs	Held in the manager's systems; export on exit can be slow
Lock-in	Apache-2.0 code, your database, portable records — leave any time	Notice periods and auto-renewal clauses in the contract

Ranges are indicative of the Victorian market and are not a quote from any particular manager. Check your own management contract for the exact fee, commission disclosure, notice period and renewal terms.

CHANGING MANAGERS IN VICTORIA — THE PRACTICAL STEPS

The general shape under the Owners Corporations Act 2006 (Vic). Not legal advice, but enough to know it's doable and to plan the timeline.

- 1 Read the management contract first. Find the term and the termination or notice clause — commonly 1–3 years, often 1–3 months' written notice, frequently auto-renewing. This clause, not the software, sets your timeline.
- 2 Line up a majority before the meeting. Appointing or removing a manager is an ordinary resolution — over half the entitlement value that votes. Talk to owners first so the vote is a formality.
- 3 Get it on an agenda. Put a motion to the committee or a general meeting. If the committee won't act, owners holding 25%+ of lot entitlements can requisition an SGM.
- 4 Vote — at a meeting or by ballot. Victoria lets the owners corporation decide by ballot outside a meeting, so you needn't wait for the AGM.
- 5 Give notice and set a changeover date. Send the manager written notice as the contract requires; agree a date to hand over records, funds and account access.
- 6 Migrate the building. Import lots, owners, levy history and documents; upload the certificate of currency; a new Monoova PayID is provisioned for levy receipts. The onboarding wizard does this with the committee in an afternoon.

If your contract is unusual or the manager disputes leaving, Consumer Affairs Victoria and VCAT are there to help.

SECTION 3

The hard questions, answered honestly

“Is our data safe?”

Yes — and you don’t have to take our word for it, which is the point. GoodStrata is open source under Apache-2.0, so anyone can read exactly what the code does with your building’s information. Self-host it on your own PostgreSQL database and nothing ever leaves your machine — the AI can even run locally, with no API key and no data sent anywhere. We proved it at launch by running a 12-lot Fitzroy building on a single laptop with a local model. Prefer not to run servers? The hosted service keeps data in Australia under the Australian Privacy Principles, each OC’s records segregated. Either way, every read and write is on an append-only log.

“Who is liable when an agent acts?”

The owners corporation and its committee remain the decision-makers, exactly as today. GoodStrata is a tool, not a legal person standing in your place: agents only propose, and a human approval executes anything with legal weight — adopting a budget, engaging a contractor, commencing debt recovery. The numbers that matter are computed by deterministic, tested code. If a decision is ever questioned, you hold a complete, timestamped record of who approved what and on what evidence. Keep your office-bearers cover and the OC’s insurance as you do now. This is not legal advice, but on liability you are never worse off than with a human manager — and your records are better.

“What does it actually cost?”

Nothing. Not freemium — free. You self-host, or use the hosted free tier, and the OC pays no subscription and no per-lot fee. GoodStrata survives two honest ways: a small, transparent margin on the payments that move through the platform (levies in, contractor payments out), every cent on the audit log; and a paid managed-hosting service for buildings that don’t want to run it. What it refuses to take is the invisible money — insurance commissions and contractor kickbacks — that defines the traditional model.

“What if the AI gets it wrong?”

Two things protect you, and neither is “trust the AI.” First, the work that must be exact is never done by the AI at all — apportionment, interest, reconciliation and vote weighting are deterministic, tested code. Second, the AI’s judgement calls can only propose; anything with consequences stops at a decision gate and waits for a human. Because every model tool-call is logged, when the AI is wrong you see it and correct it before it matters. At launch, a local model tried to dispatch the same work order twice; a state guard rejected the duplicate, and exactly one work order existed. The model narrates; the ledger is the truth.

“How hard is it to switch in Victoria?”

Less hard than the fear of it. Changing managers is an ordinary resolution of the owners corporation — a simple majority of the entitlement value that votes — and the real constraint is usually your existing contract’s notice period, not the technology. Buildings change managers routinely; you are allowed to leave. The migration itself is the easy part: GoodStrata imports your lots, owners, levy history and documents, provisions a new payment reference for levies, and walks the committee through it with an onboarding wizard. The six practical steps are set out on the previous page, and the resolution wording to start is overleaf.

SECTION 4

Suggested committee resolution

Copy the wording that fits your decision onto the meeting agenda. Adjust the bracketed details for your building. Either resolves as an ordinary resolution.

MOTION A – ADOPT GOODSTRATA (SELF-HOSTED)

That the owners corporation [Plan of Subdivision PS _____] resolves to:

1. end / not renew its agreement with the current manager, [_____], in accordance with the notice provisions of that contract;
2. adopt GoodStrata (Apache-2.0, self-hosted on infrastructure controlled by the owners corporation) to conduct its operational functions, with all financial and legally significant actions subject to committee approval; and
3. authorise the committee to set the changeover date, take receipt of records and funds, and complete migration and onboarding.

MOTION B – ADOPT GOODSTRATA (MANAGED HOSTING)

As Motion A, with clause 2 replaced by:

2. engage the GoodStrata managed-hosting service (data held in Australia under the Australian Privacy Principles, records segregated per owners corporation) to host and operate the platform, with all financial and legally significant actions subject to committee approval.

Next steps – this week

- Open the live demo. Click anything at demo.goodstrata.com.au — it resets itself, so you can't break it. Ten minutes is enough to see a levy run, an arrears chase and a maintenance dispatch.
- Circulate this pack. Share it and the one-pager in the building's group chat or on the noticeboard before the meeting, so the answers are already in the room.
- Add one agenda item. Ask the chair to add “Review GoodStrata” to the next committee meeting.
- Decide, then migrate. If the committee is in, run the onboarding wizard against your real plan of subdivision, or self-host from github.com/goodstrata/goodstrata.

THE FACTS, ALL CHECKABLE

Free for owners corporations — no subscription, no per-lot fee. Open source (Apache-2.0) — read or self-host the code. Audit-first — every action on an append-only event log. No hidden commissions — nothing on insurance, nothing from contractors. You decide — agents propose, humans approve.

goodstrata.com.au · demo.goodstrata.com.au · github.com/goodstrata/goodstrata

This pack is general information about the GoodStrata platform and the process of changing managers in Victoria. It is not legal, financial or insurance advice, and every building's circumstances differ. Verify your own contract terms and, where needed, seek advice from Consumer Affairs Victoria, VCAT or a qualified professional.